

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of D major (three sharps), and 2/2 time. The melody is characterized by a mix of 2/2 and 3/2 measures, creating an irregular feel. Chords are indicated by letter names (E, B, A) and guitar-style fingering diagrams (e.g., 1 4 2, 3 2 1 1, 2 1). The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across measures. The score concludes with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...